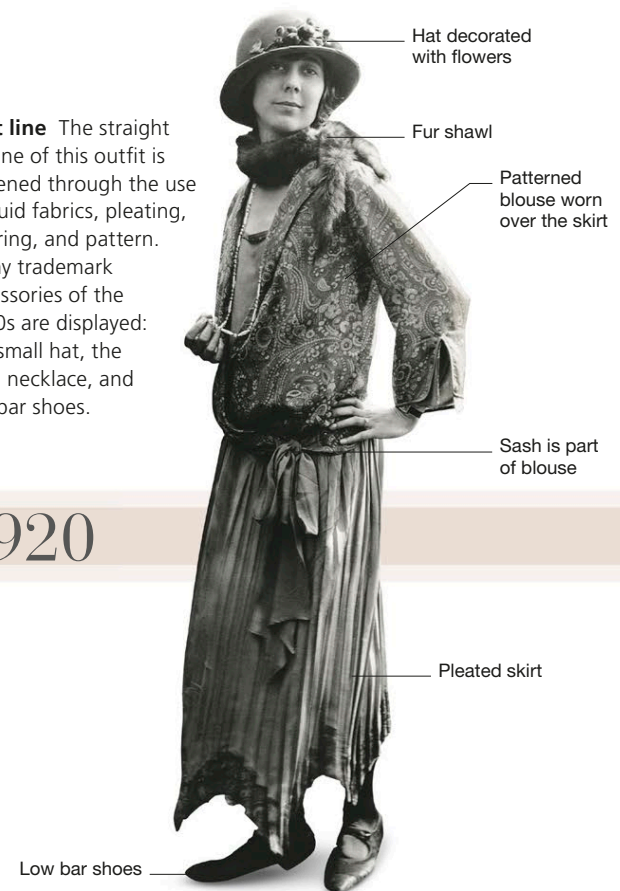


1920–1929

RISING HEMS

Victor Margueritte's scandalous novel *La Garçonne*, published in 1922, describes the transformation of a young woman into the "tomboy" of the title. The androgynous, youthful look came to represent the decade, though not every woman could carry it off. Thankfully there were several styles to choose from, as long as they had a low waist. Hemlines rose and dropped at least twice, skirts being at their shortest around 1927. The gowns' straight silhouettes were often broken up or emphasized by geometric decoration, and different colours could be used for the top and bottom halves. Fuller skirts remained in fashion, becoming more prominent when hemlines were lower. The tight, bell-shaped cloche hat with its diminishing brim became universally popular and indicated that its wearer's hair had been cut fashionably short, but hats with wide brims also remained in vogue.

Soft line The straight outline of this outfit is softened through the use of fluid fabrics, pleating, layering, and pattern. Many trademark accessories of the 1920s are displayed: the small hat, the long necklace, and the bar shoes.



1920

LINGERIE

While women could choose from a bewildering array of undergarments, they all served one purpose: to reduce or entirely remove any curves that even vigorous dieting could not eliminate. Brassières had been introduced the previous decade but now shrank into a flattening band. Knickers remained large and could also be attached to camisoles to form "cami-knickers". Artificial or real silk, crêpe de Chine, and georgette in pink, peach, apricot, or brighter colours such as cyclamen (pink) replaced white cotton. Edgings and inserts were made of lace. Corsets were still used but now often took the shape of girdles compressing the hips with and without the help of elastic.



1925

1926



Folk dress The shape of this short day dress is a mixture of the simple tubular silhouette and the more voluminous *robe de style*. The colours and style of the embroidery might have been derived from the traditional dress of Eastern Europe.

Similar theme Both women sport the tubular silhouette with a low waistline and hem just below the knee. Variations are provided by the use of different outer garments, shoes with and without bar, and different hat styles.